GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

May 30th, 2025
Week 22
Volume 272, Issue 1187

Highlights:

- **New Season.**
- **Liquid Gold.**
- **Ping-Pong.**
- **Milkshake?**
- **Pak far behind.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"If everyone is thinking alike, then somebody isn't thinking."

– General George Patton

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

JUNE JITTERS!

The ongoing season of "Tariff Dramas" continues on in exciting fashion as this week, Team Trump turned the heat on steel imports into the country levying fresh tariffs on nations currently exporting various grades of the metal to the U.S., which is unquestionably set to dampen global steel prices and ship recycling sentiments across the Indian sub-continent once again. Every week is now intent on bringing with it, an entirely new economic reality for the world to re-adjust to, turning everyday business practices into an extremely erratic and volatile way of conducting any type of practical international trade, which stands to deliver a year of buckled performances, given that key global economic indicators are increasingly displaying the ill-effects of. Oil, the liquid gold powering the engines of the planet, continues to slip week after week as it fell over 1% and closed the week out at USD 60.40 / barrel, all while the back and forth between Trump and the Appeals courts saw the reversing and reinstating of tariffs within the span of just 12 hours, further adding to the uncertainty and unpredictability of (global) trade laws that are being tossed around in a petulant battle of authoritative ping-pong and has led to a fight at the U.S. Supreme Courts. Freight rates too are being subjected to conflating performances across weeks as only last week did the markets witness charter rates fall, to see them rise back up as the Baltic Dry Exchange Dry Index soared a whopping (nearly) 5% this week, driven primarily on the back of the Cape size sector, which itself reported a 10.6% jump, reaching the highest levels seen since April of this year.

On the receiving end of the mental economic milkshake is the sub-continent ship recycling sector, which, in addition to the above, has also seen subjected to unpredictable tonnage availability across much of 2025, along with a fresh batch of monsoon rains that ingloriously kicked-off across the sub-continent markets this week. And as has been case for sub-continent recycling markets, the rains will deliver the conventional decline in demand and pricing, regardless of availability of tonnage at the bidding tables over the next quarter or so. Currencies too continue to take a beating as nearly all of the major ship recycling destinations reported declines against the U.S. Dollar, except Pakistan, which also (surprisingly) reported more arrivals this week, than neighboring India has over the last 2. Indian recyclers have clearly endured another difficult week following the fragile cessation of an armed conflict with Pakistan, as Indian offers on tonnage have notably retreated by over 5% since the peaks seen of early May.

In terms of yards getting ready for the Hong Kong Convention, Pakistani recyclers remain some ways behind all of their industrywide counterparts and despite some initial works reportedly taking place, not a single yard in Gadani will be anywhere near HKC ready by June 26th, thus eliminating this vital sector until they get their ducks in a row. Bangladeshi recyclers on the other side, have demonstrated clear progress as yards continue to seek HKC approvals and an impressive collection of ocean-front businesses and recycling yards continue to be developed into a photograph-worthy scene. Finally, Turkey on the far end has nothing to report, other than another drop in the Lira. Overall, as we enter the rainy season, the likelihood that this festering buffet of bad economic decisions will inevitably deliver a market correction remains high, particularly as tariffs on steel prices (the prime mover of offers from global recyclers) are yet to settle in the coming week(s).

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 22 of 2025 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

GETTING TIGHT!

Upgrades continue.

Despite upgrade works continuing at pace in Bangladesh in an effort to get all local ship recycling yards approved to HKC standards prior to the June 26th deadline when the convention officially enters into force, realistically it seems as though only an additional 2 or 3 yards will be approved in the next few weeks, with the rest then playing catch up and unable to buy / import any vessels until their facilities are developed to the required standards and approved thereafter. Presently, of the nine domestic yards with HKC approvals, several have opted to remain inactive and are not negotiating vessels and a majority of the rest are filling up rapidly with leftovers from cash buyers' unsold inventories that were delivered across recent weeks. It is therefore expected that the next batch of sales will likely be diverted to competing markets, due to the increasingly limited capacity of open HKC buyers in Chattogram. This has also seen prices start to cool as a satiated market diverts its attention towards recycling its recent deliveries in line with the HKCs requirements.

Yards filled.

Local fundamentals meanwhile continue to demonstrate increasing volatility, especially after the interim government's move to let market forces dictate the value of the Taka as required by the terms of the current IMF loan agreement, one that has seen the currency collapse from region BDT 106 against the U.S. Dollar from about a year ago, down to a massive BDT 122.16 on the back of a 33-basis point drop this week alone. Local steel plate prices also have been restrictively supportive of ongoing offers from local buyers as after Pakistan, Bangladeshi recyclers have the best margins in the industry with steel retreating a mere USD 1/Ton down to close at USD 555/Ton this week. This has certainly helped this market set the bar for the impressive volume of ongoing weekly deliveries into Chattogram (save for a few close calls) as HKC approved buyers welcomed at least 2 more units into port limits this week, more than both its competing neighbors **combined**.

LNGs sold?

Moreover, with four LNG vessels that were recently sold for recycling from the Korean market, which included two Moss and two Membrane types, the richer in non-ferrous Moss types usually end up in Alang given India's propensity to beat recycling industry average offers on rich / non-ferrous loaded units, and the comparatively less rich might even see a diversion to a local HKC yard. The remaining yards will have a way to step away from the bidding tables until they get their infrastructure in place and audits concluded, meaning many will not be fully ready by June 26th when the Convention finally enters into force.

Flavors of June.

Domestically, the political situation continues to present challenges in the face of upcoming budget and even elections, given that boycotts and strikes by government employees at the Secretariat Office in Dhaka is presenting its own challenges and ensuing delays in getting any pending matters resolved in timely manner will contribute to delays in grants and approvals on incoming vessels and yards upgrades. The rains have meanwhile soaked everything down for everyone to take a breather as domestic movements too have slowed, an expected return to life in the wet lane.

June will undoubtedly have its share of excitement for this market, just depends on if it's your flavor.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

PRECARIOUS LEVELS!

Disastrously declining Indian steel plate prices and a currency that is backtracking its recent progress has seen the Indian market fall to precarious levels over the last month. While the U.S. Dollar made a 55-basis point gain against the Indian Rupee and ended the week at Rs. 85.57, it was Indian steel plate prices that the made the most stunning of manoeuvres as they sky dived USD 12/Ton, down to a lowly USD 441/Ton and left local recyclers increasingly likely to take a hit on incoming deliveries - especially on the large LDT Stainless Steel units that are heading to Alang and generally take longer to recycle, which will spell trouble in the face of declining fundamentals, incoming steel tariffs, and a perennially nervy sentiment that will, like Bangladesh, present a muddy milkshake of its own flavour through the rains.

5% down.

Alang offerings have meanwhile registered a downward correction of about 5% through May, on the back of the incredible and ongoing volatility that remains ready 24/7 and a certain degree of panic begins to increasingly permeate Alang buyers in the face of a growing possibility that an increasing amount of tonnage would be forcibly diverted to Indian shores, given the overall lack of any HKC infrastructure upgrades in Pakistan so far, along with the fact that many Bangladeshi yards are still undergoing upgrades and those that were recently upgraded aren't negotiating fresh units for the time being. Making matters worse is that June 26th stands a mere 4 weeks away and with tariff uncertainty still ahead of the Supreme Court of the United States, it could be a messy end of Q2 and perhaps largely Q3.

Diversions?

Although Alang recyclers like their Bangladeshi counterparts, have managed to take in tonnage that is not only geographically better suited for an Alang re-delivery, but even specialist (non-ferrous rich / SS units) and HKC units designated for an India only resale, a majority of these have gone missing of late and resulted in tonnage disappearing from Alang shores over recent weeks as not a single new vessel has arrived Alang's OPL over the last 2 weeks, and the only vessels currently idling outside have done so over the same time frame. Notwithstanding, there remains a lingering expectation that at least two of the recently sold LNGs (MOSS types in particular), will likely head to Alang and alleviate the ongoing state of recycling affairs.

Perhaps busier.

On the broader economic front, India and the U.S. continue to duke out the tariff debates with the WTO and it seems as though things might end on a positive note for the Indian administration after all, given that the country is now the 4th largest economy in the world - even surpassing Japan. This certainly presents a negotiating edge for the Indian economy across recent and troubling times and has helped keep the nation's economic trajectory on the right path, with an inflation rate of about 3.15% and is nearly to that of pre-pandemic times. Coupled with the lack of any HKC upgrade needs and despite facing immense pressure on offers at the bidding tables, India might ironically become the go to market for June. Funny how that is.

Funny how that is.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

RUDIMENTARY!

Upgrades needed.

Rudimentary and basic upgrade work has reportedly commenced at a few ship recycling yards in Gadani who realize that their time may well be on the clock without the relevant investment and approvals, as the HKC inches ever closer to enforcement on June 26th. But at the current rate of progress, things aren't looking good for this market despite a recently renewed interest and aggression to buy, which has seen Pakistani buyers reportedly secure a few geographically suitable, small(er) LDT units of late, the arrival of one of which broke Pakistan's dry anchorage spell that lasted over 4 weeks, even beating India out for the number of arrivals this week.

Renewed aggression.

Yet, the overall state of Gadani yards reports a bleaker overall picture for the nation's critical sector and local buyers certainly have more than some ways to go before they get even starting to initiate infrastructure upgrades, let alone get anywhere near filling that many empty yards that have been empty for a majority of time over the last 2 quarters.

Pakistan's economic fortunes, meanwhile, have certainly turned onto a better path with the recent release of IMF's USD 1.3 billion bailout package that saw Pakistani fundamentals conjointly registering their individual shares of improvements across the week. While the Pakistan Rupee strengthened 26 basis points against the U.S. Dollar and ended the week (below PKR 282 again) at PKR 281.77, local steel plate prices themselves registered a modest USD 4/Ton jump as the week closed out, further keeping local sentiments balanced.

Too late?

Pakistan's upcoming budget is scheduled on or around June 10th and is expected to address items in line with the IMF that further require the Pakistani government to focus on domestic anti-terrorism activities. This tranche from the IMF along with a sensible budget should help local recyclers speed up development works so as to stay relevant in a post June 26th world, as all the financial stability in the world would amount to nothing if no owners or cash buyers are willing / able to diver their tonnage towards non-HKC yards along Gadani's shoreline.

Overall, while the chances of securing any (if at all) tonnage until June 26th remains minimal, one thing is for certain. In the face of rising freight rates, prospective recycling tonnage disappearing from the bidding tables once again, and most units that will come for sale will likely be an HKC only unit, feels like we might bid adieu to Gadani for the time being.

Silent end.

A sad silent end to Gadani's 2025 performance seems imminent.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

WHOOSH!

39.16.

And just like that, Turkey's disappeared from the bidding tables as market tonnage availability returns to zero, and the Lira continues to drag local sentiments down without mercy as it loses 42 basis points this week and ends it at TRY 39.16 against the U.S. Dollar.

Import and local steel plate prices too have remained relatively unchanged since last week and with that, we'll see you all next week.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 22 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Weak**	440 / LDT	460 / LDT	470 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Weak**	430 / LDT	450 / LDT	460 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	420 / LDT	440 / LDT	450 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Weak**	250 / LDT	260 / LDT	270 / LDT

WEIRD ONES!!

- ***Pitch perfection -*** *Having "perfect pitch" doesn't just mean you can be a talented singer: This ability allows people to precisely identify musical notes. In other words, they can hear a D minor and name it on the spot. The condition is incredibly rare—less than 1 in 10,000 people have true perfect pitch. Scientific experts debate whether people are born with the ability or if they can learn it; some studies suggest that—with enough dedication and training—you may be able to develop perfect pitch.*
- ***A second row of eyelashes -*** *Those with distichiasis carry a second set of eyelashes that grow from the inner mucosal layer of the eye. According to Medscape, the defect happens when epithelial germ cells fail to differentiate between certain glands. This can be a makeup artist's dream come true—think lush lashes, no help needed. But for some, extra lashes can irritate the eye and cause problems like tearing, inflammation, and corneal ulcers—if you have these issues, check an optometrist first.*
- ***Ability to survive at high altitudes -*** *Anyone who has hiked to the top of any mountain knows that high altitudes can be brutal. But did you know some indigenous groups like Tibetans are able to survive at altitudes as high as Mount Everest? Researchers believe their rare ability comes from years of evolution. Their ancestors who lived in high regions for thousands of years developed red blood cell adaptations that make it possible to survive with insanely low levels of oxygen.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
June 07 – Bakri-Eid	May 24 – June 01 June 09 – June 17 June 22 – June 30

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
June 07 - 12 – Eid-ul-Azha	June 11 – June 14 June 24 – June 27

BANK HOLIDAYS		
CHINA	**PAKISTAN**	**TURKEY**
May 31 – June 02 – Dragon Boat Holiday	June 05 – Day or Arafah June 06 - 09 – Eid-ul-Azha	June 05 – 09 – Kurban Bayrami

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ALANG - Port Position as of May 30, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Lord 17	2,583	General Cargo	Arrived May 11
2	Nirvana	9,623	Oil Tanker	Arrived May 07
Total Tonnage		**12,206**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of May 30, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Fianit*	*745*	*Fishing Vessel*	*Delivered May 27*
2	Futong Express	8,857	Woodchip Carrier	Arrived May 22
3	*Huaquan*	*1,413*	*Supply Vessel*	*Delivered May 28*
4	*Long 1*	*10,634*	*Woodchip Carrier*	*Delivered May 29*
5	Sidimi	2,985	RoRo Cargo Vessel	Arrived May 16
		24,634		

GADANI - Port Position as of May 30, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Pete	10,176	Bulk Carrier	Arrived May 27
Total Tonnage		**10,176**		

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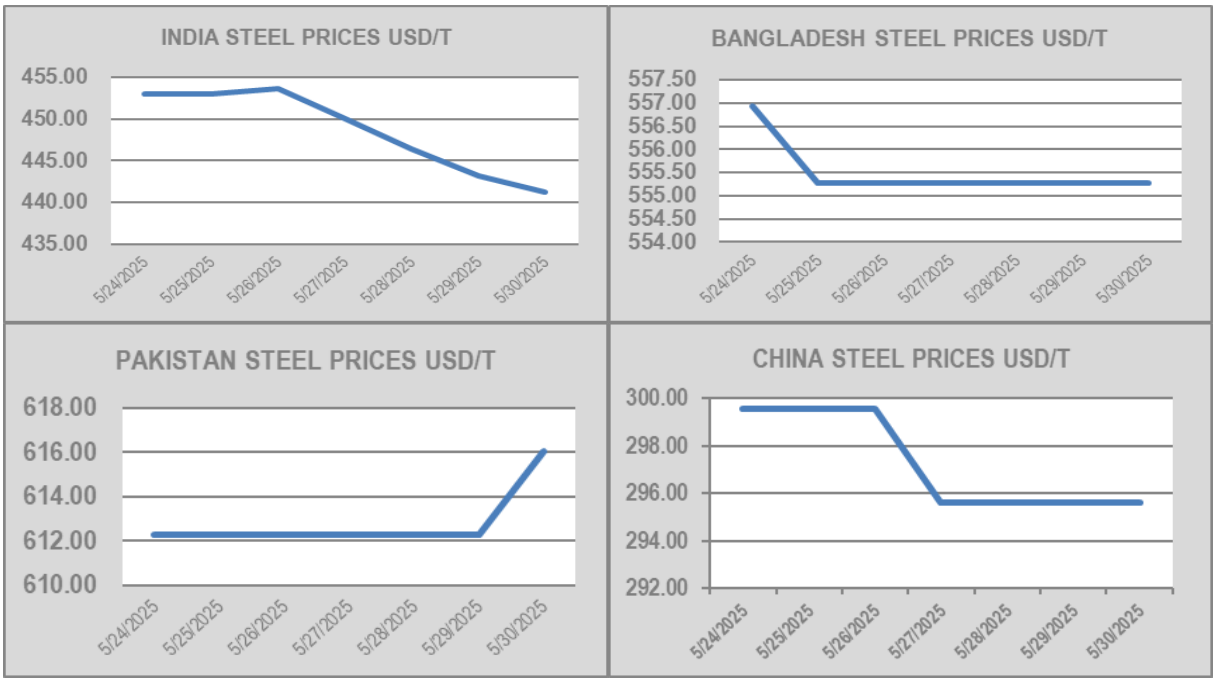
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
5/24/2025	453.00	38,600.00	612.28	173,000.00	556.93	67,500.00	299.57
5/25/2025	453.00	38,600.00	612.28	173,000.00	555.28	67,300.00	299.57
5/26/2025	453.64	38,600.00	612.28	173,000.00	555.28	67,300.00	299.57
5/27/2025	450.02	38,400.00	612.28	173,000.00	555.28	67,300.00	295.65
5/28/2025	446.34	38,100.00	612.28	173,000.00	555.28	67,300.00	295.65
5/29/2025	443.22	37,900.00	612.28	173,000.00	555.28	67,300.00	295.65
5/30/2025	441.30	37,700.00	616.04	174,000.00	555.28	67,300.00	295.65



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